

CAMERAS ARE FINALLY GOOD

The Galaxy Z Fold 8 has a 50MP primary camera and a new 50MP ultra-wide camera, along with 10MP selfie cameras on the cover and inner displays. And, in a nutshell, the cameras are really good.

Starting with the primary camera, it produces excellent photos in almost every lighting condition I have tested it in. I took a bunch of photos in London, and the colours turned out pleasing with strong dynamic range, and Samsung's image processing also does a great job of producing shots that are ready to share. I also really like how easy it is to use the cover screen as a viewfinder when taking selfies with the 50MP primary camera. You get a much better camera to work with, and the cover display makes it easy to frame yourself before taking the shot.

The ultra-wide camera is perhaps the bigger surprise. The 50MP sensor gives it more detail than what we have traditionally seen from foldable phones, and I really like the consistency between the primary and ultra-wide cameras, especially when it comes to the tone and the colours. As always, the lens does a fine job of capturing a wider field of view, which comes in handy when you want to fit more into the frame.

In good light, both cameras deliver excellent results. Even in more challenging conditions, they hold up well. The last time I used a fold, which was the Fold 6, I know I can't say with the



same confidence that the Fold 6's camera was something I could completely rely on. With the Fold 8, though, I can. If I pull the phone out of my pocket to take a photo, I have confidence that it will give me a good result. And that is a big deal.

The 10MP selfie cameras on both the cover and inner displays are also perfectly capable for video calls and of course, the selfies. They do a good job in well-lit conditions, although I would still recommend using the 50MP primary camera whenever possible.

Of course, there is still one glaring omission — the telephoto camera. I really wish Samsung had managed to squeeze one into the Fold 8. The digital zoom works surprisingly well in good lighting. Samsung's processing is good enough to make the results look

convincing, particularly at moderate zoom levels. But once the light drops, you start seeing the limitations. Details become softer, noise creeps in, and the image simply does not have the same confidence as something captured using a proper telephoto lens. And that is when you find yourself thinking, if only Samsung had added a telephoto camera. It would have sealed the deal for me.

Again, don't get me wrong. The camera system is good enough that I am comfortable relying on it. Let's put it this way — the S26 Ultra is my benchmark for smartphone cameras. The Fold 8 does not beat it.

VERDICT

The Galaxy Z Fold 8 is not perfect. As I said, some apps still need to catch up with the new aspect ratio. The lack of a telephoto lens is felt, particularly in low light. Also, it is not the best camera phone. That crown still belongs to the Galaxy S26 Ultra for me. And then there is the premium flagship price.

For what it's worth, Samsung has finally figured out the book-style foldable should be. It should be compact when you want a phone. It should become a canvas when you need more screen. It should be light enough to carry. It should be powerful enough to replace your flagship. Most importantly, it should not feel like you are compromising because you chose a foldable.

– Aman Rashid



SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Elite Gen 5 | RAM: 12/16 GB LPDDR5X | Storage: 1 TB UFS 4.1 | Cover Display: 5.5-inch Dynamic AMOLED 2X | Inner Display: 7.6-inch Dynamic AMOLED 2X | Refresh Rate: 1-120 Hz | Brightness: 3000 nits | Camera (Rear): 50 MP + 50 MP | Camera (Front and inner display): 10 MP + 10 MP | Battery: 4800 mAh | Charging: 45 W Wired, 20 W Wireless

CONTACT

Company: Samsung | Phone: 1-800-5-726-7864 | Email: Web form | Website: www.samsung.com/in/

Read more on Digit.in:
tinyurl.com/fd938ds